AMMU LAVANYA

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Education

The George Washington University
Ph.D. in Economics — May 2027 (Expected)

Jawaharlal Nehru University
M.A. in Applied Economics (graduated top of the class) — July 2016 – May 2018

University of Delhi
B.A. (Honours) in Economics (graduated with distinction) — July 2013 – May 2016

Research Fields

Primary Fields: International Finance, Monetary Economics, Empirical Banking, Financial History
Secondary Fields: Macro-Development

Job Market Paper

International Financial Flows, Credit Allocation and Productivity

This paper examines how financial liberalization shapes domestic credit allocation and real economic outcomes using detailed bank-firm matched data for India. We exploit a 2004 reform that raised foreign shareholding limits in Indian banks and identify differences in credit allocation patterns across banks with varying exposure to foreign capital inflows. More exposed banks received larger capital inflows, which relaxed their funding constraints and expanded their overall lending. This increase in bank lending was directed towards the more productive firms in the economy, raising their investment and reducing the overall dispersion of marginal revenue product of capital (MRPK) across firms. This improvement in credit allocation was associated with foreign equity inflows rather than foreign debt financing, highlighting the importance of the form of capital inflows. Quantifying the aggregate effects of this reallocation, we find that the liberalization generated significant gains in total factor productivity (TFP).

Research in Progress

A History of the Future of Emerging Markets
with Atish R. Ghosh

Do Open Capital Markets Spur Growth? Evidence from Asian Countries, 1820-1931
with Graciela Kaminsky and Zheyu Yang

Monetary Policy Transmission to Consumption: Evidence from Transaction-Level Data
with Donghao Wu

Research Experience

Research Officer, International Monetary Fund — January 2025 – Present

Research on the growth prospects of emerging market economies and the IMF's response to the GFC
Worked on a project evaluating the evolution of IMF's program design and conditionality
Data analysis and research support for the IMF History Project

Fund Internship Program, International Monetary Fund — June 2024 – August 2024

Evaluated the design, financing-adjustment mix and outcomes of IMF supported programs between 2000-2019

Research Specialist, Institute for International Economic Policy — June 2022 – August 2022

Constructed and analyzed a long-run database (spanning 200 years) of international debt issuance for Asian economies

Project Associate, Centre for Development Studies — August 2019 – March 2020

Drafted policy briefs and designed surveys for a study on the developmental implications of international remittances
Engaged with municipal government officials and local stakeholders to obtain data and facilitate fieldwork

Research Internship Program, Reserve Bank of India — July 2018 – August 2019

Empirical research on the crowding-out effects of fiscal imbalances on private sector investment in India
Data analysis and analytical inputs for the RBI's flagship publication *"State Finance Report: A Study of Budgets 2019–20"*

Pre-Ph.D. Publications

The Openness-Inflation Puzzle: An Asymmetric Approach

with Irfan Ahmad Shah. *Macroeconomics and Finance in Emerging Market Economies*, 15(2): 125–139, 2022.

Does Government Deficit Crowd Out Private Investment? An Empirical Analysis for National and Sub-National Governments

with Pushpa Trivedi, Sangita Misra and Kaushiki Singh. *ICFAI University Press Journal of Applied Economics*, 18(3): 7–36, 2019.

Teaching Experience

Instructor, The George Washington University Summer 2025, 2026

Principles of Macroeconomics and Principles of Microeconomics (Undergraduate)

Teaching Assistant, The George Washington University Fall 2021 – Fall 2024

Principles of Microeconomics (Undergraduate): Fall 2021, Fall 2023

Principles of Macroeconomics (Undergraduate): Spring 2022, Fall 2022, Spring 2023, Spring 2024, Fall 2024

Other Work Experience

Graduate Intern, Ministry of Statistics (MoSPI), Government of India June 2017 – July 2017
Research Intern, Rural Development Institute, India June 2015 – July 2015
Academic Trainee, National Stock Exchange of India June 2014 – July 2014

Awards, Fellowships & Honors

Frédéric Bastiat Fellowship, Mercatus Center 2025
CCAS Doctoral Fellowship, The George Washington University 2026
John Kendrick Summer Fellowship, The George Washington University 2023
John Whitefield Kendrick Graduate Fellowship, The George Washington University 2022
Columbian Distinguished Fellowship, The George Washington University 2020-2025
Joan Robinson Prize, Centre for Development Studies, Jawaharlal Nehru University 2018
Principal's Honour Roll, Indraprastha College for Women, University of Delhi 2016

Conferences and Presentations

NEUDC, ASSA (Scheduled) 2026, 2027
IMF Research Department Seminar 2026
III Congress Globalization and Growth in the History of East and Southeast Asia 2025
Macro-International Lunch Seminar, The George Washington University 2024, 2025
Internal Seminar, Strategy Policy Review Department, International Monetary Fund 2024
Annual Conference, Department of Economic and Policy Research, Reserve Bank of India 2019
Department of Economic and Policy Research Study Circle, Reserve Bank of India 2019

Skills and other information

Languages: English, Hindi, Telugu
Technical Skills: Stata, Matlab, Python, EViews, Microsoft Office, LaTeX
Certifications: Numerical Summer School (Essentials and Advanced), London School of Economics
Citizenship: India

References

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Department of Economics
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Roberto Samaniego
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Atish R. Ghosh
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Last updated: October 2026